=TREND(known_ys,known_xs) in a cell, where *known_ys* is the historical data interval and *known_xs* is the future period interval.

- **Regression analysis**
  Statistical regression techniques enable the analysis of relationships between various variables and the prediction of future outcomes. Specifically, follow these steps:

  1. Collect data on the variables you wish to analyse and determine the type of regression analysis to perform.
  2. Install and activate the *Analysis ToolPak* add-in (analysis tools) in Excel.
  3. Select the data range to be analysed and open the *Regression* tool from the Data Analysis menu of *Analysis ToolPak*.
  4. Choose the type of regression analysis to be performed, enter the input and output ranges, and select other options or restrictions to apply.
  5. Examine the regression results to determine the statistical significance of the variables and the accuracy of the model.

- **Scenario analysis**
  Scenario analyses can be used whenever it is necessary to create and test different scenarios based on various assumptions to identify potential outcomes. To do so, follow these steps:

  1. Create a financial model in Excel based on given assumptions and data.
  2. Duplicate the model in a separate worksheet or workbook.
  3. Modify the assumptions and inputs of the duplicate model to create different scenarios. In these cases, in addition to using different input variables, it is useful to take advantage of the computational rules to observe the effects of different scenarios on the financial forecast. For instance, the *IF* function and *Scenarios* feature in the *Data* tab which allow you to create financial models based on different scenarios.
  4. Compare the results of each scenario to determine potential outcomes.

- **Monte Carlo Simulation**